

Method Swap Challenge Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 35-45 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	35-45 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	method-swap-challenge

Big idea: Methods carry assumptions about what can be known and how it should be justified.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Method Swap Challenge Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Method Swap Challenge Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Question: Is this policy fair? Method card: mathematical proof. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Method Swap Challenge Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Question: What caused this revolution? Method card: controlled experiment. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Method Swap Challenge Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Question: What caused this revolution? Method card: controlled experiment. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Methods carry assumptions about what can be known and how it should be justified.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Method Swap Challenge Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Method Swap Challenge Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How do methods shape what can be known?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Question: Is this policy fair? Method card: mathematical proof.
- Question: What caused this revolution? Method card: controlled experiment.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

Activity Steps

1. Groups draw one knowledge question and one method from different AOKs.
2. They attempt to answer the question using the assigned method.
3. Groups identify what the method reveals, distorts, or cannot handle.
4. Students swap to a more suitable method and compare results.
5. Debrief why methods are powerful but not interchangeable.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How do methods shape what can be known?
- Can a method be reliable in one AOK and misleading in another?
- What is gained and lost when knowledge practices cross boundaries?

Knowledge Questions

- How do methods shape what can be known?
- Are standards of justification transferable across AOKs?
- What does method choice reveal about knowledge?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with a claim examined using scientific experiment, historical source analysis, and artistic interpretation. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...